3.2 Why Spain Settled Texas

4th Grade Social Studies · Video: Motivations for Spanish Settlement of Texas (San Antonio Missions NHP (MissionsNPS))

Name: _____ Date: _____

Watch the video and fill in the blanks as you go.

The Three Gs

The three Gs, God, Glory, and _____, help explain why Spain settled Texas and the New World.

Spanish explorers looked for gold and _____ for economic opportunity.

The King of Spain wanted to expand his _____ against rival European kings.

The King also wanted to spread the Roman _____ faith to all Indigenous peoples in the New World.

Why Spain Waited

The Spanish found that gold and silver were practically _____ in Texas.

Most Indigenous people in Texas lived in small groups of _____ hunter-gatherers.

Large amounts of gold and silver were found in what is today _____, so Spain focused its efforts there.

The French Threat

The threat of a _____ invasion in 1684 made Spain focus on Texas again.

King _____ of France also wanted to expand his empire.

_____ arrived at Matagorda Bay by mistake in the 1680s.

La Salle started a settlement there, but he was killed by his own _____.

When Spanish troops found the French _____ in 1689, no one was left alive.

Spain Settles Texas

France and Spain both rushed to build _____, or forts, plus settlements and missions.

Spain believed that to conquer is to _____.

Spanish settlers from the _____ came to San Antonio as colonists.

The Spanish Crown sent _____ to educate and convert Indigenous peoples.

San Antonio Missions National Historical Park has four missions, one ranch, dams, _____, and an aqueduct.

Spanish _____ is still an important influence in Texas, and French culture is still important in Louisiana.

Vocabulary

Word	Meaning
empire	a group of lands ruled by one king or government
nomadic	moving from place to place instead of staying in one spot
presidio	a Spanish fort
colonist	a person who settles in a new land for their home country

Key Takeaways

• Spain came to Texas for God, Glory, and Gold.

• Spain first focused on Mexico, where gold and silver were found.

• The French settlement led by La Salle pushed Spain to build presidios, missions, and settlements in Texas.